



COMM200 PERSUASIVE SPEECH

Republic Is Not Democracy

Representation without participation is oligarchy.

A political system can look democratic while moving power away from citizens.

Source: Wikimedia Commons, A.Savin, CC BY-SA 3.0

THE CORE DECEPTION

One vote is not the same as power.

Elections can authorize rulers without giving citizens command over law, agenda, or accountability.

Source: Freedom House, 2025

Elections Are Not Rule

- Res publica names a public interest.
- Officeholders define that interest from above.
- Citizens choose rulers, then disappear from command.
- No agenda power means no continuous sovereignty.



ARGUMENT 2

Representation Replaces Participation

The direction of power is reversed.

Citizens

source of legitimacy

Parties

candidate filter · program filter · discipline

Parliament

law after options are already managed

Oligarchy Reproduces Itself

Oligarchy does not need
secrecy. It needs access.

- Party machines control entry.
- Economic power controls influence.
- Media visibility controls attention.
- Appointments control enforcement.

50/100

Corruption perception score · Greece

Access becomes the real constitution: who enters, who is heard, who is protected, and who is ignored.

Accountability Breaks When Information Is Pressured

Without independent information,
citizens cannot judge power.

86/180

Press freedom rank · Greece

- Institutional pressure
- Wiretapping concerns
- SLAPP pressure
- Information control

SATISFACTION

Democracy Requires Constitutional Tools, Not Just Democratic Language.

Referendum. Initiative. Recall. Audit. Independent justice.

The Choice Is Structural

Republic as Oligarchy

- Voting ritual
- Party command
- Elite bargaining
- Opaque decisions
- Managed people

Constitutional Democracy

- Citizen rule
- Direct mandate
- Recall
- Public audit
- Accountable institutions

Power to the People

- Reject voting-only democracy.
- Demand constitutional reform.
- Demand popular referenda.
- Demand recall powers.
- Demand legislative initiative.

Representation is not participation.



References

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